

Vine Tomato Information Pack

Introduction

Our grower for vine tomatoes is based in West Sussex, close to the sea on some of the southernmost farmland in the UK. This means the glasshouse captures an incredible amount of sunlight and produces premium tomatoes that are easily comparable to those ripening in the Italian sun, minus the air miles!



Farm Information

This glasshouse has been in operation for 50 years and grows multiple varieties of tomatoes in a carefully controlled environment. Each plant is trimmed, trussed, maintained and harvested by hand throughout the growing season, and all of the waste is composted locally and returned to the soil around the site.

Plants need both water and carbon dioxide to produce sugars for growth. Excess CO₂ produce elsewhere on the site for heating and energy generation is pumped back into the glasshouse to encourage further growth, reducing the overall carbon footprint of the site. The glasshouse covers 7.5 acres, which is a huge roof space and a great opportunity to collect water. Gutters and drains collect and direct the water into an on-site reservoir that doubles as a wildlife project, supporting waterbirds, insects and native flora. The water is then pumped back into the glasshouse to irrigate the crop as needed.

Making tomato sauce has always been a way of storing summer surplus for out of season use. Cooking and jarring tomatoes is a tradition rooted deeply in Italian cuisine. We are drawing on this history with this product. These tomatoes are technically a surplus crop, they may have fallen off the vine during packing, or simply went unsold due to high yields in the week. Hence the incredibly competitive price! They are no less delicious or nutritious, just a side product of a sadly wasteful food system, but not if you have anything to do with it!

More

They are also a LEAF certified farm, which is a strong and robust sustainability credential.